

Brass Crosby

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Brass Crosby was born in Stockton in 1725. He trained as a lawyer and later became Lord Mayor of London in 1770.

As Chief Magistrate, he opposed naval press gangs, which forced men to join the navy. He also defended a printer who published reports about Parliament and refused to punish him. Because of this, Crosby was sent to the Tower of London, causing protests across the country.

After six weeks, he was released and welcomed back with celebrations. His actions helped protect freedom of the press and stopped the use of general warrants.

Crosby married in 1772, lived in Chatham Place, and died in 1793. An obelisk at St George's Circus was built to remember him.



Brass Crosby as Lord Mayor of London



Chatham Place and Blackfriars Bridge